

STATUTORY COOPERATIVE DISPUTE RESOLUTION MANUAL
STATE COOPERATIVE OMBUDSMAN AUTHORITY 2025

Chapter IV: Jurisdiction and Powers of the Cooperative Ombudsman

Section 18: Subject Matter Jurisdiction

The Cooperative Ombudsman shall have exclusive statutory jurisdiction to investigate and adjudicate complaints regarding:

1. Arbitrary refusal or delayed admission into PACS membership.
2. Financial irregularities, embezzlement, or uncredited passbook deposits exceeding Rs. 50,000.
3. Wrongful denial or deduction of crop insurance claims and interest subvention benefits.
4. Malicious rejection of agricultural credit without written speaking orders.

Section 20: Limitation Period for Appeals

Any aggrieved farmer or society member must file an appeal before the Ombudsman within 60 calendar days from the date of the Society's rejection order, or within 90 days if the Society has failed to communicate any resolution.

Section 23: Punitive Damages and Personal Penalties

Where the Ombudsman concludes that an officer, secretary, or committee member has acted with willful negligence, corrupt intent, or malicious delay:

- a) The Ombudsman may award compensatory damages up to Rs. 25,000 payable to the complainant from the Society reserve.
- b) The Ombudsman may recommend immediate recovery of such amount from the personal emoluments of the guilty officer.
- c) In severe cases of persistent non-compliance, the Ombudsman can direct the Registrar of Cooperative Societies to initiate disqualification under Section 36 of the Act.

Section 25: Enforceability and Binding Nature of Orders

Every order passed by the Cooperative Ombudsman shall be final and binding on the Cooperative Society. The Society Managing Committee must implement the award and report compliance within 30 calendar days from receipt of the certified order.